



Stakeholder Mapping

Week 6 • Day 1 • Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

TPM Academy



Day 1 Objectives

- Build a **complete stakeholder list** — not an org-chart copy
- Place every stakeholder on a **Power × Interest grid**
- Assign **RACI** to the 5 most consequential decisions, with one A per decision
- Build a **watch list** — the high-power-low-interest stakeholders + their triggers
- Draft **SEP §1** — the input to engagement planning tomorrow



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin TCD §6 sign-off matrix on the wall
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Build the stakeholder list (the 5 circles)
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Power × Interest mapping
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	RACI for 5 decisions
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Watch list + SEP §1 polish

Block 1 — Build the List

Org chart $\neq$ stakeholder map



The Five Circles

- **Customer-facing:** customer success, sales, support
- **Engineering-adjacent:** architecture, security, platform, infra, data, QA
- **Operating partners:** ops, IT, compliance, legal, finance
- **Decision-makers:** PM lead, eng director, GM, executive sponsor
- **Indirect interest:** other product teams whose work this touches

Most rookie lists are 5–7 names. A complete list is usually 10–18.



What Good Looks Like

- Each stakeholder has a **name** (or named role) — not "the security team"
- Each has a **one-sentence concern** — what they care about
- Each has a **relationship to this feature** — consumer, owner, gate

Watch for: "TBD" entries. Force a name. The unowned stakeholder is the one who blindsides you.

Activity 1 — Build the List

Triads • 35 minutes

- 5 min: copy from TCD §6
- 15 min: walk the 5 circles, augment
- 5 min: light cull
- 10 min: capture role + concern per stakeholder



5 + 15 + 5 + 10

Block 2 — Power × Interest

Where each stakeholder lives



The 2x2 Grid

High Power, High Interest

Manage closely — key partners; frequent deep engagement

Low Power, High Interest

Keep informed — engaged audience; you'll learn from them

High Power, Low Interest

Manage with authority — the surprise-veto quadrant

Low Power, Low Interest

Monitor — low effort; periodic check-ins

The dangerous quadrant: high-power, low-interest. They surprise you with a "no" at the worst time.



Worked Example (FieldPulse)

High-Interest, High-Power: Eng Lead
Customer Success Lead
QA Lead

<p>High-Interest, Low-Power: Other dispatcher squads
Internal users testing</p>
<p>Low-Interest, High-Power: Architect
Eng Director
Security Lead
CFO</p>

Low-Interest, Low-Power: Internal communications
Ops floor

Surprise: Compliance is low-interest in the abstract but high-power in specific moments (audit deadlines). Position can shift.

Activity 2 — Power × Interest

Triads • 40 minutes

- 5 min: sketch 2×2
- 15 min: place each stakeholder; argue when you disagree
- 10 min: name engagement style per quadrant
- 10 min: identify your 2 "surprises"



5 + 15 + 10 + 10

Block 3 — RACI

One A per decision; if two, neither is



RACI Refresher

Letter	Role	Definition
R	Responsible	Does the work. Many R's possible.
A	Accountable	Owens the outcome. Exactly one per decision.
C	Consulted	Two-way; opinion sought.
I	Informed	One-way notification.

The discipline: if two people are A, neither is. If no one is A, the decision rots.



The Five Decisions

1. **Scope** — what's in vs out
2. **Architecture** — TCD §1 + key trade-offs
3. **SLO targets** — TCD §4
4. **Launch date** — when it ships
5. **OOS backlog ownership** — deferred items + owners

The TPM rookie error: "I'll be A for architecture." The architect is A. You're C.



Worked RACI

Decision	R	A	C	I
Scope	TPM	PM Director	Eng Lead, Architect, CS	Sales, Support
Architecture	Architect	Eng Director	TPM, Security, Platform	All eng
SLO targets	Eng Lead	TPM	SREs, CS	Eng Director
Launch date	TPM	PM Director	Eng Lead, CS, Marketing	All eng, Sales
OOS backlog	TPM	TPM	Eng Lead	Backlog readers

Activity 3 — RACI for 5 Decisions

Triads • 40 minutes

- 20 min: draft matrix
- 5 min: "no two A's" check
- 10 min: "is the A actually empowered?" check
- 5 min: "anyone surprised by being I?"



20 + 5 + 10 + 5

Block 4 — Watch List + Polish

The early-warning system



The Watch List

For each **high-power-low-interest** stakeholder, identify the event that would move them to high-interest — and the trigger to escalate engagement.

Stakeholder	Trigger to escalate
CFO	Cost projection > \$X
General Counsel	Any regulator email
Chief Customer Officer	Top-10 customer escalation
Architect	Architecture stance changes after Day 1

The watch list is your early-warning system. Distinguishes managers of stakeholders from reactors to them.

Day 1 AI Prompt

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Role: Senior PM coaching a junior TPM on stakeholder management.  
Context: <stakeholder list="" with="" quadrants="" and="" raci="">  
Task: Identify 3 likely blind spots:  
1. A stakeholder who probably has more power than the map shows  
2. A decision where the A is wrong or absent  
3. A high-power-low-interest stakeholder whose trigger isn't named  
Constraints:  
- Be specific to names and roles given  
- Do not invent stakeholders  
Format: 3 numbered findings, each with one-sentence rationale.</stakeholder>
```

Activity 4 — Watch List + Polish

Triads • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: polish §1
- 20 min: build watch list (3–5 stakeholders + triggers)
- 5 min: cross-check vs TCD §6
- 5 min: AI prompt + provenance note



15 + 20 + 5 + 5 • 15-min wrap



Day 1 Wrap

What we built

- Comprehensive stakeholder list
- Power × Interest grid
- RACI for 5 decisions
- Watch list with triggers
- SEP §1 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **Managing engagement for outcomes**
- Per-stakeholder engagement plans
- Cadence + format + asks

Bring to Day 2: SEP §1. Tomorrow we plan the actual engagement.

Questions & Reflection

Whose attention have you been spending too much on? Too little?